



TENSOR STRENGTH

TENSOR STARTER

4-WEEK BEGINNER STRENGTH + FITNESS FOUNDATION

THE STANDARD

LEARN. BUILD. PROGRESS.

Progressive training. Clear standards. Measurable execution.

FORMAT

A/B FULL BODY

EMPHASIS

FOUNDATION + FITNESS

STANDARD

TECHNIQUE FIRST

PROGRAM BRIEF

A simple 4-week foundation for new lifters learning to train consistently.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Beginners or returning trainees who want a full-body plan with straightforward exercise selection, manageable soreness and clear progression.

SCHEDULE

Week	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3
1	Workout A	Workout B	Workout A
2	Workout B	Workout A	Workout B
3	Workout A	Workout B	Workout A
4	Workout B	Workout A	Workout B

PROGRESSION

- Week 1: RPE 6 - learn the movements and leave about four reps in reserve.
- Week 2: RPE 6-7 - add a small amount of load or one rep where prescribed.
- Week 3: RPE 7-8 - productive work, still no grinding.
- Week 4: RPE 8 - complete the heaviest clean training of the block.

LOAD INCREASES

When all reps are clean: add 2.5-5 lb to upper-body free-weight exercises, 5-10 lb to lower-body exercises, or one small machine increment. If technique gets worse, keep the same weight.

WORKOUT A

Full-body strength with simple movement patterns.

Exercise	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Rest
Goblet Squat	3x8 RPE 6	3x9 RPE 6-7	3x10 RPE 7-8	3x8 heavier RPE 8	90s
Machine Chest Press	3x8	3x9	3x10	3x8 heavier	75-90s
Lat Pulldown	3x8	3x9	3x10	3x8 heavier	75-90s
DB Romanian Deadlift	2x10	3x10	3x10 heavier	3x8 heavier	90s
Machine Shoulder Press	2x10	3x10	3x10 heavier	3x8 heavier	75s
Seated Leg Curl	2x12	2x12 heavier	3x12	3x10 heavier	60-75s
Plank	2x30s	2x40s	3x40s	3x45-60s	45s

WARM-UP

- 5 minutes easy bike or treadmill.
- Bodyweight squat x10, hip hinge x10, band row x15, arm circles x10 each direction.

CONDITIONING

Incline treadmill walk: 5 minutes Week 1, 7 minutes Week 2, 8-10 minutes Week 3, 10-12 minutes Week 4. Keep a conversational pace.

WORKOUT B

A second full-body day that reinforces the same fundamental movement skills.

Exercise	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Rest
Leg Press	3x10 RPE 6	3x11	3x12	3x10 heavier RPE 8	90s
DB Bench Press	3x8	3x9	3x10	3x8 heavier	75-90s
Cable Row	3x8	3x9	3x10	3x8 heavier	75-90s
Roman Chair Hyperextension	2x10	3x10	3x12	3x12 heavier	60-75s
Split Squat	2x8/leg	2x9/leg	3x8/leg	3x10/leg	90s
DB Lateral Raise	2x12	2x15	3x12	3x15	60s
Dead Bug	2x8/side	2x10/side	3x10/side	3x12/side	45s

ENDURANCE PROGRESSION

Week	Bike / Rower
1	6 min easy-moderate
2	8 min
3	10 min
4	12 min

MOVEMENT & MOBILITY

Use this short sequence before either workout when you feel stiff.

Movement	Prescription	Purpose
Deep Squat Hold	2x20-30 sec	Ankles / hips / squat comfort
Half-Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch	2x30 sec/side	Hip extension
Wall Slide	2x8	Shoulder control
Dead Hang or Supported Lat Stretch	2x20 sec	Shoulders / lats
Single-Leg Balance	2x20 sec/side	Proprioception
Low Pogo Hop - optional	2x10	Elastic ankle stiffness; only if comfortable

STARTER STANDARD

No exercise needs to hurt to be effective. Use a comfortable range, stable setup and smooth tempo. Stop a set when technique changes, even if reps remain on paper.

HOW TO CONTINUE

What to do after the first 4 weeks.

- Repeat the block with slightly heavier starting loads if all movements feel confident.
- Move to a more advanced program only when the current one feels predictable and technique is consistent.
- A beginner does not need constant exercise changes. Repeating movements is how skill and strength develop.
- Track loads and reps in the website tracker so each session starts from the previous result.

PROGRESSION RULE

Earn load increases through repeatable technique. The goal of the Starter program is not to prove strength; it is to build the movement base that lets strength grow safely and quickly later.

EXERCISE NOTES

Execution standards for the movements used in this program.

GOBLET SQUAT

Hold the dumbbell close to the chest, brace, sit between the hips and keep the entire foot connected to the floor.

LAT PULLDOWN

Pull the elbows toward the ribs while keeping the torso controlled. Let the shoulders reach upward between reps.

LEG PRESS

Use a foot position that lets the knees track comfortably. Lower only as far as the pelvis stays controlled.

ROMAN CHAIR HYPEREXTENSION

Hinge through the hips and finish in a straight-body position rather than overextending the lower back.

DEAD BUG

Keep the ribs down and lower back controlled while opposite arm and leg move away from the body.

MACHINE CHEST PRESS

Adjust the seat so the handles line up around mid-chest. Keep the upper back supported and press smoothly.

DB ROMANIAN DEADLIFT

Push the hips back, keep the dumbbells close to the legs and stop when hamstring tension limits a neutral position.

CABLE ROW

Sit tall and pull the handle toward the torso without turning the movement into a body swing.

SPLIT SQUAT

Stay balanced over the full front foot and lower under control. Use support if balance limits the exercise.

PLANK

Create a straight line from head to heel, squeeze glutes and keep the ribs stacked over the pelvis.